

EEE3096S Website Maintainer Guide

Embedded Systems II — Course Website

Last updated: July 2026

This guide is intended for course staff responsible for maintaining the EEE3096S static course website. No web development experience is assumed. All tasks described here involve editing plain text files only.

1. Site Overview

The website is a static site built on the HTML5 UP Arcana template. “Static” means there is no server-side processing — the site is a collection of plain files (HTML, CSS, JavaScript, images, PDFs) that the browser downloads and displays directly.

The pages of the site are:

File	Purpose
<code>index.html</code>	Homepage — course description, course info table, announcements panel
<code>lectures.html</code>	Lecture slides listing
<code>practicals.html</code>	Practical assignments listing
<code>links.html</code>	Useful external links
<code>archive.html</code>	Archived content from previous years
<code>announcements.html</code>	Full announcements listing (all announcements)

All resource files (PDFs, images, markdown announcements) live in the `resources/` folder.

2. Posting Announcements

Announcements are written as Markdown files and stored in `announcements/`. The homepage automatically displays the 3 most recent announcements. The full list appears on `announcements.html`.

2.1. Step 1: Write the announcement file

Create a new plain text file in `announcements/` named following this pattern:

```
Announcement_001.md
Announcement_002.md
Announcement_003.md
```

The number must increment by one each time. Use any plain text editor (Notepad, VSCode, etc.). Write the content using Markdown formatting:

```
## Practical 2 Due Date
```

```
Assignment P2 is due **Friday 14 March at 5pm**. Submit via Vula.
```

```
Late submissions will be penalised 10% per day.
```

Key Markdown formatting rules:

- `## Heading` — section heading
- `**bold text**` — bold
- `*italic text*` — italic
- A blank line between paragraphs creates a new paragraph

2.2. Step 2: Register the file in the manifest

Open `announcements/announcements.json` and add the new filename to the bottom of the list:

```
[
  "Announcement_001.md",
  "Announcement_002.md",
  "Announcement_003.md"
]
```

Important: the manifest file controls which announcements are displayed. If you add a `.md` file to `announcements/` but forget to add it to `announcements.json`, it will not appear on the site.

The homepage always shows the last 3 entries in the list (i.e. the bottom 3), so newer announcements should always be appended to the bottom.

2.3. Step 3: Deploy

Save both files and upload/push them to the server as you normally would for any site update. No other changes are required.

3. When the Course Is Inactive

When the course is not running (e.g. between semesters), you may want to suppress certain content without deleting it. The recommended approach is to comment it out in the HTML.

HTML comments use this syntax:

```
<!-- This content is hidden -->
```

Anything between `<!--` and `-->` is ignored by the browser.

3.1. Suppressing the announcements panel

If there are no active announcements, comment out the announcements `<script>` in `index.html`, and uncomment the `<script>` below it to display a message about the course being inactive:

```

<!--#####
    Comment out from here if course is inactive -->
    <!-- Script fetches and parses most recent 3 announcements from
    announcements.json manifest-->

    <script>
    fetch('resources/announcements.json')
      .then(response => response.json())
      .then(files => {
        const recent = files.slice(-3).reverse();
        return Promise.all(
          recent.map(filename =>
            fetch('resources/' + filename).then(r => r.text())
          )
        );
      })
      .then(texts => {
        const html = texts.map(t =>
          '<div style="background: #f9f9f9; border-left: 4px solid #ccc;
padding: 1em 1.5em; margin-bottom: 1.5em; max-width: 700px; word-wrap:
break-word; overflow-wrap: break-word;">'

          + marked.parse(t)
          + '</div>'
        ).join('');
        document.getElementById('announcements-content').innerHTML = html;
      })
      .catch(() => {
        document.getElementById('announcements-content').innerHTML = '<p>No
announcements at this time.</p>';
      });
    </script>

<!--#####
    Comment out until here if inactive -->

    <!--Uncomment if course is inactive:
    <script>
      document.getElementById('announcements-content').innerHTML =
"Course currently inactive"
    </script>
    -->

```

4. Updating Course Content

4.1. Updating Course Staff

In `index.html` , the course staff details are displayed. To update these details, modify the following section in the `index.html` file:

```
<!-- #####  
        Modify this section to update course staff-->  
  
        <h3 style="font-size: 18px; color:green"> Lecturers: </h3>  
        Prof. Simon Winberg (Head Lecturer)<br>  
        Email:<a href="mailto:simon.winberg@uct.ac.za">  
simon.winberg@uct.ac.za </a> <br>  
        Office: Menzies 6.13 <br> <br>  
  
        Travimadox Webb (Co-Lecturer )<br>  
        Email:<a href="mailto:WBBTRA001@myuct.ac.za">  
WBBTRA001@myuct.ac.za </a>  
        <br> <br>  
  
        <h3 style="font-size: 18px; color:green"> Teaching Assistant:  
</h3>  
        Maisha Magavha  
        Email:<a href="mailto:MGVMAI001@myuct.ac.za">  
MGVMAI001@myuct.ac.za </a> <br> <br>  
  
        <h3 style="font-size: 18px; color:green"> Tutors: </h3>  
        <!--TODO-->  
  
<!-- #####
```

4.2. Adding a lecture

In `lectures.html` , each lecture is a `<section>` block. Copy an existing block and update the filename, image, and title:

```

<section class="col-6 col-12-narrower">
  <div class="box post">
    <a href="resources/EEE3096S-L04.pdf" class="image left">
      
    </a>
    <div class="inner">
      <h3>Lecture 4</h3>
      <p>Brief description here.</p>
    </div>
  </div>
</section>

```

Place the corresponding PDF and thumbnail image in `resources/` with matching filenames.

4.3. Adding a practical

The same pattern applies in `practicals.html`. Copy an existing `<section>` block and update the title, description, and file links.

4.4. Updating the course handout link

In `index.html`, find the Course Outline row in the table and update the `href`:

```

<a target="_blank"
  href="resources/Course_Handout_EEE3096S_2025.pdf">
  Download Course Handout
</a>

```

Place the new PDF in `resources/` and update the filename in the link.

5. Important Notes

- **Never edit `assets/css/main.css`** unless you are confident in CSS. Visual changes are better made using inline `style=""` attributes on individual elements.
- **The nav bar is not shared** — it is manually duplicated in every HTML file. If you add or remove a nav item, you must update all pages.
- **Announcements are ordered by position in `announcements.json`**, not by file date. Always append new entries to the bottom of the list.
- **The site requires an HTTP server to function correctly** — opening HTML files directly from the file system (double-clicking) will cause announcements to fail to load. Use Live Server in VSCode during local editing, or deploy to a proper web host.